

Proof by rebuild

Our entire cloud environment is defined in one repository, deployed by pipeline, checked by an independent auditor, and destroyed and rebuilt on demand. We do not assert that our controls work. We rebuild the environment and demonstrate it.

Audit evidence is produced continuously Every deployment records what was checked, what was expected, and what was found. Preparing for an audit becomes retrieval rather than a project.	Recovery is exercised, not documented The environment is destroyed and rebuilt as routine practice rather than an annual tabletop. Recovery time is measured, not estimated.
Cloud spend is attributable by construction Resources cannot be created without the tags that assign an owner and a cost centre. There is no unattributed spend to reconcile later.	Security fixes ship without added headcount Vulnerabilities are found, patched, tested and deployed unattended. Leadership reviews the record instead of approving each step.

152 min DESTROY AND REBUILD, MEASURED	<\$15 MONTHLY RUN COST, PARKED	65 INDEPENDENTLY VERIFIED CRITERIA	3,097 AUTOMATED TESTS
7 LONG-LIVED CREDENTIALS, LISTED			

WHAT IT REMOVES FROM THE RISK REGISTER

No unaccounted credential	Pipelines authenticate by short-lived federated identity; the database has no password to leak. Seven long-lived credentials remain, where no federated path exists, all named in the rotation list.
Drift cannot accumulate	Nothing is changed by hand. Anything that diverges from the repository fails verification and surfaces immediately, rather than being discovered during an incident.
Separation of duties is structural	The identity that deploys cannot verify, and the identity that verifies cannot write. The boundary is enforced by the system, not by policy alone.
Classified work has a governed home	Sensitivity labelling, including export-controlled handling, is provisioned as code and persists across rebuilds — a property of the environment rather than a habit of its users.

A working environment, not an architecture diagram — rebuilt end to end from an empty subscription in under three hours, unattended.